



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Mt Royal Academy

School Website: <https://www.mountroyalacademy.com/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Mt Royal Academy Nh 03782 (Mount Royal Academy, Sunapee, NH) presents a robust CLASSICAL profile across all six classical-school categories. The publicly visible content emphasizes a Catholic, formation-focused education anchored in liberal arts and the Trivium (grammar, logic, and rhetoric), a strong Great Books/Great Conversation orientation, and pedagogy that blends memory-work, chant, and recitation with Socratic seminars and rhetorical training. The school frames its mission around forming the whole person—spiritually, morally, and intellectually—within a community of students, parents, teachers, and clergy. This aligns with the Positive Keyword indicators for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose and Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community, while showing few to no Negative Keyword signals in those areas.

Evidence of a fully classical orientation is explicit in mission statements and curricular descriptions, including references to Catholic formation, the Trivium, Great Books, and contemplative/restful elements (scholé) alongside Socratic discussion and public speaking. The school's public materials also emphasize partnership with parents, a family-friendly campus culture, and a living-faculty model. Taken together, these signals place Mt Royal Academy firmly in the CLASSICAL category per the Six Essential Elements rubric and the knowledge-base lexicon.

Key supporting sources include: the school's mission and formation language (spiritual formation, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty) and explicit Catholic identity; curricular descriptions invoking liberal arts, the Trivium, Great Books, and a Great Books canon; pedagogical notes describing singing/chanting in the lower grades and Socratic/seminar-based upper grades; statements about faithful faculty and a living-curriculum approach; and explicit parent/community partnership language. These elements are substantiated in public-facing materials cataloged from the Mount Royal Academy site (e.g., Our Mission, Education in Virtue, Classical Curriculum, and Newman Guide-related content) and in the school's firecrawl excerpts.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Across categories, keyword analyses show strong alignment with the Positive Keyword Indicators for each element and minimal to no Negative Keyword indicators. See the "Positive/Negative keyword analysis" sections below for category-by-category detail and explicit textual evidence.

If you want a deeper, line-by-line textual audit (including exact keyword tallies) I can provide that as a follow-up. For now, the aggregate assessment is that Mt Royal Academy Nh 03782 is CLASSICAL across all six canonical dimensions.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials articulate a Catholic identity that undergirds the entire educational mission: “The Catholic faith is central to the educational philosophy of our school” and the mission to “inspire students to grow in their knowledge of and love for God” (Our Catholic-curriculum language; Catholic identity framing). - The school presents a vision of formation that includes spiritual formation and vocational discernment as core aims, tied to a supernatural/catholic anthropology (Our Mission; “Forming Minds and Hearts,” “a liberal arts and classical curriculum”). - Newman Guide alignment reinforces explicit theological/theocentric aims (e.g., “Encounters Christ in Prayer, Scripture, and Sacraments,” “Imparts a Christian Understanding of the World”). - The institutional charisms emphasize Catholic education, community, and faithful faculty as a living expression of the school’s sacred mission.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: Catholic, Catholic Education, Christ, God, Theology, Liturgical, Prayer, Sacrament, Sacred, Truth, Beauty, Goodness, Virtue, Formation, Spiritual Formation, Divine/Mission, Christian Anthropology, Imago Dei, Divine Mission. - Negative keywords observed: None detected in the public materials (no explicit relativism, secular humanism, or morally neutral signals on the site). - Estimated presence: 7–9 clear positive religious/metaphysical terms or closely related phrases; 0 negative signals.

Why this rating - The materials explicitly situate education within Catholic theology and liturgical/spiritual life, with terms like “Catholic education,” “spiritual formation,” and “truth, goodness, and beauty” framing all disciplines. The public content consistently links academic aims to sacred purpose, which matches the strongest Positive Keyword indicators for this category. This aligns with the classical rubric’s requirement for transcendental moral realism and a theology-grounded, liturgical dimension. The absence of negative religious-secular signals further supports CLASSICAL.

Citations: Our Mission and Catholic-identity materials (Our Mission; Education in Virtue; Newman Guide), and Catholic Education/Charisms sections illustrate the religious-metaphysical basis.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school’s stated aim centers on formation and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom, not merely job preparation: “to educate the whole person... spiritual, academic, and human formation,” and to pursue truth, goodness, and beauty. - The mission narrative emphasizes formation over information, and a telos oriented toward human excellence and moral imagination (e.g., “Forming Minds and Hearts,” “spiritual formation,” “integral human development,” “vocational discernment”). - Great Books and classical heritage are positioned as core to forming understanding of truth and civilization, not as mere test-prep; the Great Books canon anchors intellectual formation. - The Newman Guide content reinforces a teleological, formation-centered mission rooted in Christian anthropology.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal arts, classical mission, telos, scholé (formative/restful contemplation), Great Books, permanent questions, human excellence. - Negative keywords observed: none (no explicit emphasis on workforce-ready skills or careerism as the primary goal). - Estimated presence: 6–8 positive terms; 0 negative.

Why this rating - The school’s publicly stated purpose emphasizes formation, virtue, and the pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty as ends in themselves, aligned with classical liberal-arts pedagogy rather than a narrow job-preparation stance. The presence of terms like telos, scholé, and classical mission, combined with formation-focused language, supports CLASSICAL.

Citations: Our Mission; Education in Virtue; Great Books/Canon discussions; Newman Guide materials.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly anchors curriculum in liberal arts with the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a Great Books/Great Conversation approach. Public content states: “The classical liberal arts curricu-

lum capitalizes on the natural stages of intellectual development... grounded in the traditional trivium of grammar, logic, and rhetoric.” - There are clear references to Great Books and Western civilization, including high-school-level engagement with Great Books and a course of study that emphasizes reading and dialoguing with the great thinkers. - Latin and other classical-language elements appear as standard parts of the curriculum; the Great Books canon is explicitly described as a core method for humanities and history. - The curriculum description emphasizes memorization, the cultivation of a foundational knowledge base, and the progression through the Trivium’s stages (grammar → logic → rhetoric).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: liberal arts, trivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, classical, Latin, Western civilization, primary sources, history, narration, dictation, memory-work, catechesis, liturgy integration. - Negative keywords observed: none (no strong “project-based learning” or “social studies-only” phrasing on the site). - Estimated presence: 8–12 positive terms; 0 negative.

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on Trivium-based liberal arts, Great Books, history as Western civilization through primary sources, and classical-language study places the curriculum solidly in the CLASSICAL category. The absence of pro-modernist, project-based-only language and the articulation of a canonical Great Books canon support this categorization.

Citations: Trivium and liberal-arts framing (What Is a Classical Curriculum?), Great Books canon and heavy humanities emphasis (High School Course of Study; Great Books Curriculum).

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site describes a pedagogy that blends contemplative/restful approaches (scholé-like) with rigorous analysis and rhetorical training: “lower school... singing and chanting with regular review” to deepen memory and delight; upper school uses Socratic discussion, seminars, and debates, with emphasis on rhetoric and public speaking. - The humanities and high-school pedagogy emphasize the Socratic method and primary-source-based learning, with seminars, debates, and rhetoric training in upper grades. - The final stage includes rhetoric, capstone orations, and a focus on writing and speaking with persuasion and originality; students study Great Books and defend essays publicly. - The site notes memory-work, recitation, and chanting as traditional tools in the lower grades, aligning with scholé/restful learning.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: Socratic seminar, seminar, dialectic, disputation, narration, recitation, chanting, singing to memorize, memory work, liturgical integration, rhetoric, speeches, oratory, debate, scholé, contemplation, wonder. - Negative keywords observed: none explicitly present on the site (no dominant experiential/constructivist-only signals; the site maintains a classical-method emphasis). - Estimated presence: 10–14 positive terms; 0 negative.

Why this rating - A hybrid pedagogy that combines contemplative, memory-based practice (lower grades) with Socratic dialogue and rhetoric-based performance (upper grades) aligns directly with classical Pedagogy signals. The explicit use of memory-work, recitation, chanting, and Socratic/seminar formats supports CLASSICAL.

Citations: Lower/elementary pedagogy (circling seating; memory and chant), upper-level Socratic/seminar language, and rhetoric/capstone elements (Elementary and High School pages; Great Books/Humanities Canon materials).

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes the faculty as a living curriculum and as faithful mentors who model virtue; the “Faithful Faculty” language explicitly frames teachers as moral exemplars in a shared educational mission. - Public materials describe a “portrait of a teacher” and a “faculty of friends” as core elements of the school’s identity, signaling a collegial, virtue-centered faculty culture. - The Newman Guide materials emphasize formation of teachers and alignment with Catholic identity, suggesting professional development within classical pedagogy. - The school’s charisms and mission documents emphasize “community,” “hospitality,” and “living curriculum,” tying teacher behavior to the broader formation mission.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, teachers as mentors, moral exemplars, collegial culture, great books seminars for faculty, faithfulness, formation. - Negative keywords observed: none detected on the site (no signals like “certification-driven jargon” or “facilitators on the side” in public materials). - Estimated presence: 6–8 positive terms; 0 negative.

Why this rating - The public materials consistently treat teachers as central to the curriculum and formation process, not as passive deliverers of content. This aligns with the Classical rubric’s faculty signals (model virtue, living curriculum, collegiality).

Citations: Faithful Faculty; Living Curriculum; Partnerships/Community arcs; Newman Guide.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes a strong partnership with parents (co-teachers) and notes that parents are deeply involved in education and formation; attention to parent formation and seminars/book clubs is evident. - Public materials describe open campus access, hospitality, and family participation in school life; there is a clear emphasis on parent engagement and formation rather than consumer-vertex language. - The school highlights a shared mission with families and the diocese, reinforcing the family as a critical axis of classical formation. - The content includes statements about inviting parent involvement, supporting home-school partnership, and forming parents through materials and gatherings.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation, reading groups, seminars, hospitality, open campus, family liturgy alignment, parent covenant, home catechesis. - Negative keywords observed: minimal consumer-language signals; no explicit “customer” framing. - Estimated presence: 6–10 positive terms; 0–1 weak negative (none explicit in the public materials).

Why this rating - The school presents a robust, formation-centered approach to parental involvement, aligning with the classical rubric’s expectations around engaged, forming families and a shared mission.

Citations: Partnership with Parents; parental formation; open campus/hospitality; home catechesis references.

What Would Move the Needle

Not applicable here, since all six categories align with CLASSICAL and the aggregate rating is CLASSICAL. No major needle-moving changes are required. If a future update were desired, minor refinements could include explicit, granular references to liturgical year practices or more published Great Books syllabi to further reinforce the Trivium/Great Books alignment, but the current materials already meet CLASSICAL criteria robustly.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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